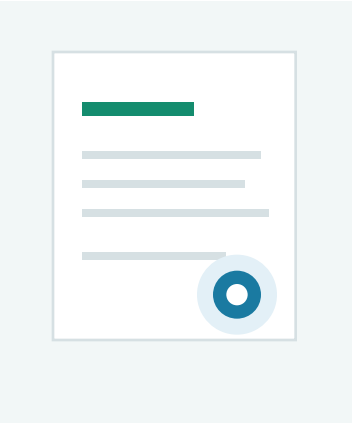
REVELATOR

See the signs.

Support the decision.

AI-assisted document forgery screening for people who need a clearer first look.



CONCEPT NOTE

STARTUP CHALLENGE SUBMISSION | OCTOBER 2026

THE IDEA

Revelator screens an image of a document or banknote for visible signs of forgery and presents a preliminary category, confidence, and plain-language findings for a person to review.

A screening signal, never a substitute for expert examination.

SUMMARY

Document verification is part of everyday work in education, public service, employment, finance, and small business. Many frontline teams rely on visual checks or have limited access to specialist review. Revelator is a web and mobile-capable prototype that uses vision AI to screen uploaded or photographed documents for possible alteration, erasure, tracing, digital fabrication, obliteration, and currency concerns. It explains what it noticed and keeps a reviewable scan history.

POSITIONING

A practical first-line review aid. Results depend on image quality and model behavior; a clean screen is not proof of authenticity.

Make the first review more informed.

PROBLEM BACKGROUND

Documents carry decisions about identity, education, employment, money, and access to services. A visual review can be slow and inconsistent, while subtle physical or digital changes may be difficult to spot without specialist tools or training. Smaller organizations may not have a document examiner available for every question. These needs are the problem hypothesis Revelator will validate with local users, not a claim that all document checks are currently failing.

PROPOSED SOLUTION

01

CAPTURE

Take a photo or upload an image.

02

SCREEN

AI checks for visible forgery indicators.

03

EXPLAIN

See a category, confidence, and findings.

04

REVIEW

A person decides whether to escalate.

PROTOTYPE FEATURES

Photo and file upload; screening across 15 forgery-method categories; confidence and plain-language explanation; visible evidence annotations when available; scan history and review notes.

OBJECTIVES FOR A FIRST PILOT

- Measure category-level precision and recall on consented, representative examples.
- Track false positives and false negatives on both genuine and altered documents.
- Test whether explanations help staff decide when to request expert review.
- Assess capture usability, review time, data handling, and willingness to adopt.

IMPORTANT LIMIT

Image screening cannot verify every feature of a physical document. Refer high-stakes or uncertain cases to qualified reviewers.

Built for teams that need a useful first look.

INITIAL TARGET MARKET

Start with Philippine organizations that review many documents but may not have forensic staff on site: school registrars and admissions teams; local government service desks; small employers and lenders; and document-intensive small businesses. These are prospective pilot segments, not current customers.

VALUE PROPOSITION

ACCESSIBLE

A familiar photo-first workflow for web and mobile-capable use.

EXPLAINABLE

A screening category and visible indicators support a human review.

RESPONSIBLE

Confidence and limitations keep the result framed as preliminary.

MARKET ALTERNATIVES AND DISTINCTION

Alternatives include manual checks, referral to a forensic specialist, and document verification products focused on identity or data matching. Revelator's proposed distinction is method-oriented visual screening with a review explanation, aimed at helping a person decide what deserves closer inspection. Pilot interviews will test where it complements, rather than replaces, existing controls.

SDG ALIGNMENT

SDG 16 | PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

Supports more informed document review in service settings.

SDG 9 | INDUSTRY, INNOVATION AND INFRASTRUCTURE

Applies accessible AI to a practical verification workflow.

PROPOSED BUSINESS MODEL

Validate a free individual entry tier and paid institutional subscriptions priced around reviewer seats or usage, with onboarding and support. Managed analysis credits or private deployment may be offered if pilots confirm demand and unit economics. This is a proposed model; commercial pricing and provider costs are not yet validated.

Prove the value with a careful pilot.

OPERATIONS PLAN

1. Prepare
Confirm needs, consent, handling, and review protocol.

2. Evaluate
Test representative genuine and altered examples.

3. Pilot
Run a small, human-reviewed partner pilot.

4. Improve
Review errors and feedback before expanding.

SIX-MONTH VALIDATION ROADMAP

MONTHS 1-2	Partner discovery, privacy review, pilot design
MONTHS 3-4	Curated evaluation, baseline error analysis, usability tests
MONTHS 5-6	Limited pilot, iteration, evidence-based go/no-go decision

RESOURCE REQUIREMENT AND USE OF FUNDS

Ask: early-stage pilot funding, technical mentorship, introductions to pilot institutions, and AI/compute credits. Exact cash amount: [insert requested amount after confirming supplier quotes].

35%	Product refinement and security
25%	Evaluation and responsible data stewardship
20%	Pilot setup, training, and support
10%	Hosting and analysis costs
10%	Accessibility and outreach

RISK AND SAFEGUARDS

False alerts or missed signs; poor image quality; sensitive records. Use human review, clear limitations, consent, restricted access, and a defined retention policy before each...

PROGRESS AND NEXT PROOF POINT

A working prototype supports image submission, AI-assisted screening, explanations, and scan history. No external pilot result or independently validated accuracy is claimed here. The next milestone is a documented pilot evaluation using both genuine and altered examples, with error rates and reviewer feedback reported transparently.

FOUNDING TEAM

STUDENT-LED PROJECT TEAM

Founder names, school, roles, and relevant achievements: [add before submission].

Revelator helps people look closer. People remain responsible for the decision.